

MATERIAL STUDY

The paper that softens light

Spring light is generous and, through a bare window, harsh. The oldest Japanese answer is *washi* — handmade paper of mulberry fibre, the material of *shōji* screens and Akari lamps. It does not block light; it disperses it, turning a hard beam into an even glow that falls without shadow. A paper pendant or a paper shade is the cheapest way to own a piece of this — a thousand-year-old technology for being kind to a room.

"Paper doesn't dim the light. It teaches it manners."

